

Worksheet — Chapter 1: A Letter to God / Dust of Snow / Fire and Ice (Class 10 CBSE English)

Total marks: **30** · Questions: **11**

Instructions: Attempt all 11 questions. Show your reasoning where required. Total time: 50 minutes.

Q1. Who wrote 'A Letter to God'? [1 mark]

- (A) Robert Frost
- (B) Gregorio López y Fuentes
- (C) Nelson Mandela
- (D) James Herriot

Q2. How much money did Lencho ask God for? [1 mark]

- (A) 50 pesos
- (B) 70 pesos
- (C) 100 pesos
- (D) 1000 pesos

Q3. In 'Dust of Snow', the bird is an owl. [1 mark]

- (A) True
- (B) False

Q4. In 'Fire and Ice', fire stands for _____. [1 mark]

Q5. How does the postmaster respond to Lencho's letter? [1 mark]

- (A) He files it away
- (B) He laughs at first, then takes it seriously and arranges a reply
- (C) He sends Lencho a sermon
- (D) He tears it up

Q6. What is the central irony of 'A Letter to God'? [2 marks]

- (A) it rains in winter
- (B) the very people who helped Lencho are accused by him of being thieves
- (C) the postmaster is fat
- (D) the field is white

Q7. Why does Lencho write a letter to God? What does this show about him? [3 marks]

Q8. Why does Frost choose a CROW and a HEMLOCK TREE for the imagery of 'Dust of Snow'? [3 marks]

Q9. How does Frost link two NATURAL forces with two HUMAN emotions in 'Fire and Ice'? [3 marks]

Q10. Discuss 'A Letter to God' as a study of FAITH and IRONY. What does the story teach about human nature? [6 marks]

Q11. What unifies 'A Letter to God', 'Dust of Snow' and 'Fire and Ice' as a chapter? Discuss with examples. [8 marks]

Answer Key

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Q1. Who wrote 'A Letter to God'?

Answer: Gregorio López y Fuentes

Mexican author.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-01

Q2. How much money did Lencho ask God for?

Answer: 100 pesos

100 pesos.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-03

Q3. In 'Dust of Snow', the bird is an owl.

Answer: False

It's a CROW.

TRUE_FALSE · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-DOS-01

Q4. In 'Fire and Ice', fire stands for ____.

Answer: desire

Desire.

FILL_BLANK · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-FAI-02

Q5. How does the postmaster respond to Lencho's letter?

Answer: He laughs at first, then takes it seriously and arranges a reply

Compassionate response.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-04

Q6. What is the central irony of 'A Letter to God'?

Answer: the very people who helped Lencho are accused by him of being thieves

Central irony.

MCQ · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-05

Q7. Why does Lencho write a letter to God? What does this show about him?

Answer: After the hailstorm has destroyed his crop, Lencho's only hope is GOD. He believes God will help, so he sits down that night and writes a letter to God asking for ONE HUNDRED PESOS to plant his fields again and live till the next harvest. He addresses the envelope simply 'To God' and posts it. This shows: (i) his UNSHAKEABLE FAITH; (ii) his PRACTICAL nature — he names a specific amount with a specific purpose; (iii) his SIMPLE conviction.

Faith + character.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-03

Q8. Why does Frost choose a CROW and a HEMLOCK TREE for the imagery of 'Dust of Snow'?

Answer: In Western literary tradition, the CROW is often a symbol of bad luck or sadness. The HEMLOCK TREE is a poisonous evergreen — in classical antiquity, hemlock was the poison given to Socrates. Both are 'dark' images. Frost CHOOSES them deliberately and uses them to DELIVER joy — a quiet REVERSAL. The poem's message: even the gloomy parts of life and nature can deliver UNEXPECTED blessings. Starting with dark symbols makes the moment of joy more startling and meaningful.

Symbolic reversal.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-DOS-02

Q9. How does Frost link two NATURAL forces with two HUMAN emotions in 'Fire and Ice'?

Answer: Frost performs a striking link: FIRE = DESIRE; ICE = HATE. FIRE is HOT, CONSUMING and ALL-OR-NOTHING — like burning desire, lust, greed. ICE is SLOW, COLD and DEADENING — like the slow freezing of hate, indifference, vengeance. Both are NATURAL forces capable of physical destruction; Frost says both, as HUMAN emotions, are equally capable of DESTROYING WORLDS. The forces that end us are not asteroids or volcanoes — they are our own emotions.

Nature ↔ emotion.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-FAI-02

Q10. Discuss 'A Letter to God' as a study of FAITH and IRONY. What does the story teach about human nature?

Answer: The story builds on TWO interlocking themes: FAITH and IRONY. Lencho's FAITH is the engine — after the hailstorm, he writes directly to God for 100 pesos. His faith MOVES the postmaster and his employees, who do not share his religious world-view but who respect it. Their KINDNESS is HUMAN — practical, generous, anonymous. They send 70 pesos signed 'God'. Then comes the IRONY. Lencho receives the money, sees it is short, and accuses the post-office staff of stealing. The reader sees what Lencho cannot — that his world-view is so RIGID that he cannot imagine an alternative. WHAT THE STORY TEACHES — (i) Faith can be a source of strength but also of BLINDNESS. (ii) Compassion in everyday people is real even when unrecognised. (iii) Humans are CAPABLE BOTH of generosity and SUSPICION. (iv) IRONY holds a mirror to our own blindnesses.

Faith + irony.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-08

Q11. What unifies 'A Letter to God', 'Dust of Snow' and 'Fire and Ice' as a chapter? Discuss with examples.

Answer: At first glance the three pieces are very different — a Mexican short story, a tiny poem about a snowflake, a poem about the end of the world. But they share a deep theme: **SMALL THINGS HAVE GREAT POWER IN HUMAN LIFE.** (i) IN 'A LETTER TO GOD', a single hour of **HAILSTORM** destroys a year's livelihood; a **LETTER** addressed to God moves strangers to compassion; a single **MISJUDGEMENT** reveals Lencho's bitterness. Small **EVENTS** change everything. (ii) IN 'DUST OF SNOW', a tiny **SNOWFALL** from a crow's wing — the smallest physical event imaginable — repairs a person's mood. Small **NATURAL MOMENTS** heal mood. (iii) IN 'FIRE AND ICE', tiny **INTERNAL** emotions — a flicker of desire, a freeze of hate — scale up to forces that can **END A WORLD**. Small **INNER EMOTIONS**, fed and unchecked, become apocalyptic. **CONNECTION** — small **EVENTS**, small **NATURAL MOMENTS**, small **INNER EMOTIONS**. The chapter teaches the careful reader to **PAY ATTENTION** to what is small, because that is where life actually happens.

Unifying theme.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 10-CBSE-ENG-LTG-08